

Chasing truce: On the U.S. and talks between Israel and Hamas

Benjamin Netanyahu is **keener on** his government's survival than on peace

President Joe Biden's **remark** that there is real progress in talks between Israel and Hamas on a **ceasefire** and hostage deal **offers** a rare **ray of hope** in ending the 15-month-long war. Mr. Biden said he was confident that his **administration**, which has only some more days left in office, **could secure** a deal. However, experience suggests that there is no deal unless an actual deal is reached, **irrespective of** the progress in talks. Even now, there are **conflicting narratives** on the remaining **bottlenecks**. Mr. Biden says Hamas is an obstacle, while Qatari and Egyptian **officials**, who were involved in the talks, **say** Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's **refusal** to agree to anything more than a temporary ceasefire is the main hurdle. Mr. Netanyahu does not want to bring the war to an end as his **far-right** government could **collapse**. But he is ready to accept a temporary **halt** in fighting in return for **hostages**. **Hamas**, fearing that Israel would **resume** fighting once the hostages are released, **demand** a permanent ceasefire. While talks **drag on**, the **plight** of over two million people in Gaza **is** nearly forgotten. Israeli strikes have already killed 46,000 Palestinians. Most of Gaza's population lives in tent cities without enough food, drinking water, medicines and electricity.

When Israel launched the war, after Hamas's October 7, 2023 attack, it had three objectives — destroy Hamas, secure the release of hostages and **bolster** the Jewish state's long-term security. Fifteen months later, while Israel has destroyed much of Hamas's military **infrastructure** and killed its top leadership, the group has survived and transformed itself as an **insurgency**. Israel has **managed to** release very few hostages and its long-term security risks remain. While a ceasefire with Hezbollah brought relative calm to the northern border, the Houthis of Yemen are now firing missiles and drones to Israel. The country is also facing international **isolation**. The International Court of Justice is **hearing** a **genocide** case against Israel, and the International Criminal Court has issued arrest warrants against Mr. Netanyahu and former Defence Minister Yoav Gallant. Rights **organisations**, from Amnesty International to HRW, **are accusing** Israel of genocide. Mr. Netanyahu seems **unperturbed**, **thanks to** the military, political and diplomatic support that Israel still enjoys from the Biden administration. But its **inability** to **meet** its objectives even in the **tiny** Gaza Strip, its **disregard** for international law and norms and the **barbarity** with which it is attacking the Palestinians **should** shock anyone interested in the country's physical and moral **well-being**. It is already too late. Israel's leaders and their **backers** in the West should not **prolong** this **aimless** war. Mr. Netanyahu should leave Gaza in return for the release of all hostages.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

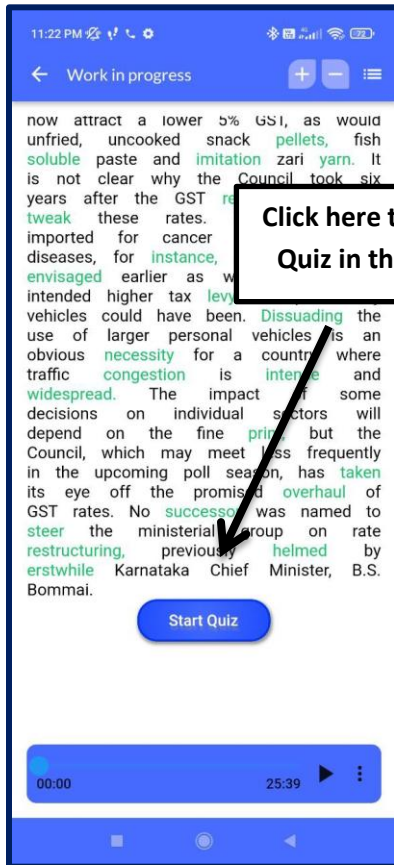
1. **Chase** (verb) – Pursue, run after, follow, hunt पीछा करना
2. **Truce** (noun) – Ceasefire agreement, armistice, suspension of hostilities संघर्षविराम
3. **Keen** (on) (adjective) – Enthusiastic about, eager for, interested in, desirous of इच्छुक
4. **Remark** (noun) – Comment, statement, observation, note टिप्पणी
5. **Ceasefire** (noun) – Temporary peace, halt in fighting, armistice, truce अस्थायी युद्धविराम
6. **Ray of hope** (phrase) – Glimmer of possibility, beacon of optimism, faint chance आशा की किरण
7. **Secure** (verb) – Obtain, gain, get hold of, ensure प्राप्त करना
8. **Irrespective of** (phrase) – Regardless of, without considering, despite के बावजूद
9. **Conflicting** (adjective) – Contradictory, opposing, inconsistent, clashing विरोधाभासी
10. **Narrative** (noun) – Account, story, version, explanation कथा/वर्णन
11. **Bottleneck** (noun) – Obstacle, impediment, hurdle, constraint रुकावट
12. **Refusal** (noun) – Rejection, denial, saying 'no', turn-down इनकार
13. **Far-right** (adjective) – Extreme conservative, ultra-right-wing अतिदक्षिणपंथी
14. **Collapse** (noun) – Breakdown, failure, downfall, end पतन
15. **Halt** (noun) – Stop, pause, standstill, break ठहराव
16. **Hostage** (noun) – Captive, prisoner, abductee, detainee बंधक
17. **Resume** (verb) – Restart, begin again, continue, pick up again पुनः प्रारंभ करना
18. **Drag** (on) (verb) – Continue tediously, go on and on, prolong, stretch out लम्बा खिंचना
19. **Plight** (noun) – Difficult situation, predicament, hardship, trouble कठिन स्थिति
20. **Bolster** (verb) – Strengthen, reinforce, support, boost मज़बूत करना
21. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Basic facilities, public works, foundational systems आधारभूत संरचना
22. **Insurgency** (noun) – Rebellion, uprising, revolt, mutiny विद्रोह

23. **Manage** (to) (verb) – Succeed in, accomplish, achieve, pull off सफल होना
24. **Isolation** (noun) – Separation, detachment, seclusion, sequestering अलगाव
25. **Hear** (verb) – Listen to, consider, take up (in a legal context) सुनवाई करना
26. **Genocide** (noun) – Mass extermination, systematic killing, annihilation, large-scale slaughter सामूहिक नरसंहार
27. **Accuse** (of) (verb) – Charge with, blame for, allege, indict आरोप लगाना
28. **Unperturbed** (adjective) – Untroubled, calm, undisturbed, unmoved अप्रभावित
29. **Thanks to** (phrase) – Because of, due to, owing to के कारण
30. **Meet** (verb) – Fulfill, satisfy, attain, achieve पूरा करना
31. **Tiny** (adjective) – Very small, minute, miniature, minuscule बहुत छोटा
32. **Disregard** (noun) – Lack of respect, negligence, indifference, disdain अवहेलना
33. **Barbarity** (noun) – Brutality, savagery, inhumanity, cruelty क्रूरता
34. **Well-being** (noun) – Welfare, good health, prosperity, comfort भलाई
35. **Backer** (noun) – Supporter, sponsor, financier, ally समर्थक
36. **Prolong** (verb) – Extend, lengthen, drag out, continue आगे बढ़ाना
37. **Aimless** (adjective) – Without purpose, pointless, directionless, purposeless बिना उद्देश्य का

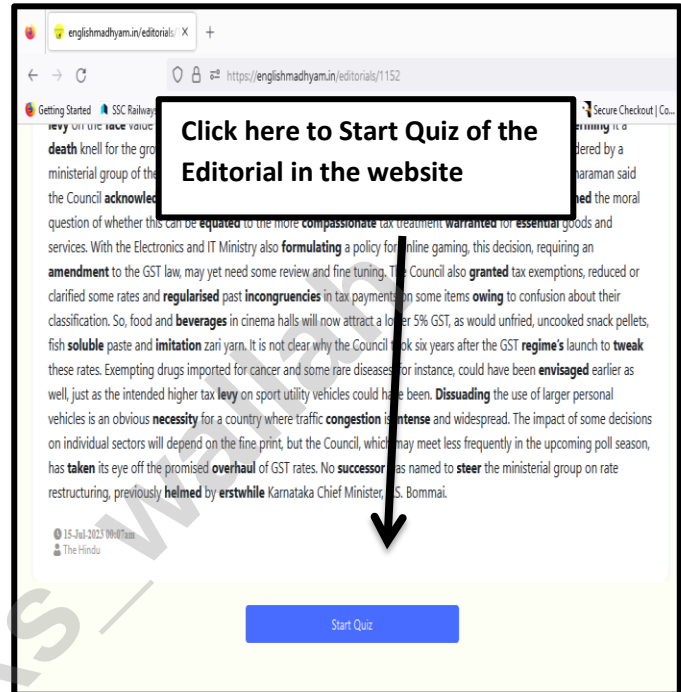
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Biden's Optimism:** U.S. President Joe Biden expressed hope for progress in talks between Israel and Hamas regarding a ceasefire and hostage deal.
2. **Negotiation Challenges:** Despite optimism, no agreement is certain until a concrete deal is reached, with conflicting narratives about the obstacles.
3. **Hamas vs. Netanyahu:** Biden blames Hamas for delays, while Qatari and Egyptian officials identify Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's refusal to accept more than a temporary ceasefire as the main hurdle.
4. **Netanyahu's Political Survival:** Netanyahu prioritizes his far-right government's survival over peace and is wary of a permanent ceasefire.
5. **Hamas's Position:** Hamas fears Israel will resume fighting after hostages are released and demands a permanent ceasefire.
6. **Humanitarian Crisis in Gaza:** Over two million Gazans face severe conditions, with 46,000 Palestinians killed and widespread shortages of food, water, medicines, and electricity.
7. **Israel's Objectives:** Israel launched the war to destroy Hamas, secure hostages, and ensure its long-term security, but these goals remain unmet.
8. **Hamas's Survival:** Despite significant military losses, Hamas has survived and transitioned into an insurgency.
9. **Hostage Situation:** Israel has released very few hostages, falling short of its stated goal.
10. **Broader Security Concerns:** While relative calm exists on Israel's northern border due to a ceasefire with Hezbollah, Yemen's Houthis have started attacking Israel with missiles and drones.
11. **International Isolation:** Israel faces growing isolation, with international courts hearing genocide cases and issuing arrest warrants against Netanyahu and former Defense Minister Yoav Gallant.
12. **Rights Group Accusations:** Organizations like Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch accuse Israel of genocide.
13. **Continued U.S. Support:** Despite criticism, Israel continues to enjoy military, political, and diplomatic backing from the Biden administration.
14. **Failure of Objectives:** Israel's inability to achieve its goals in Gaza and its disregard for international law raise concerns about its long-term well-being.
15. **Call for Resolution:** It is suggested that Netanyahu should agree to leave Gaza in exchange for the release of all hostages to end the conflict.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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